

CROWDSTRIKE FALCON OVERWATCH THREAT INTELLIGENCE

Lazarus Group (Zinc): Cross-Platform Crypto-Heist Malware and Ransomware Fusion

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OVERVIEW & CAMPAIGN ANALYSIS

CrowdStrike Falcon OverWatch has uncovered a sophisticated cyber campaign operated by **Lazarus Group** (also tracked by CrowdStrike as LABYRINTH CHOLLIMA, Zinc, and HIDDEN COBRA), an elite nation-state cyber unit operating on behalf of the Democratic People's Republic of Korea (DPRK). The operation blends financial theft targeting decentralized finance (DeFi) protocols with corporate ransomware extortion. Targeting is conducted via weaponized PDF job lure documents (MITRE Technique T1566.001) distributed to engineers on LinkedIn, deploying Rust-based implants (RustBucket) and KandyKorn backdoors.

HOST PERSISTENCE & TECHNICAL INDICATORS

Upon successful execution, the loader registers persistence on Windows hosts by creating an autorun policy under:

- HKLM\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer\Run\LzStartup

The malware family connects to command and control nodes operating over HTTPS, staging memory-only Cobalt Strike beacons and Mimikatz credential-harvesting tools (T1003). Defenders are advised to enforce immediate ingress and egress filtering on the IP addresses and domains enumerated below.

INDICATORS OF COMPROMISE (IoCs)

Type	Observed Indicator	Association / Role	Confidence
IPv4	45[.]142[.]214[.]9	Lazarus C2 Primary Node	High
IPv4	185[.]220[.]101[.]55	Crypto Wallet Drainer Proxy	High
IPv4	91[.]215[.]85[.]17	Staging Server for RustBucket	High
Domain	cryptotrade-validator[.]xyz	Phishing & Exploit Landing Page	High
Domain	blockchain-node-sync[.]io	C2 Command Dispatch Domain	High
Domain	binance-airdrop-claim[.]net	Credential Harvest Lure	High
URL	hxxps://cryptotrade-validator[.]xyz/connect/wallet.php	Malicious Wallet Drainer URI	High
SHA-256	8f4e2b027d928373b5a761e05d0452f360980590fa143c7b328a6d4e4e93f663	RustBucket macOS/Win Loader	High
SHA-256	f1d2d2f924e986ac86fdf7b36c94bcdf32beec15defc16260b30d47710273b56	KandyKorn Memory Implant	High
MD5	5d41402abc4b2a76b9719d911017c592	Stage 1 Encrypted Payload	High
Registry	HKLM\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Policies\Explorer\Run\LzStartup	Persistence Autorun Key	High
Email	recruiter[@]crypto-careers-global[.]com	Spear-phishing Social Engineering	High